

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, June 30, 2021, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Lovett at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
At-Large Councilor Dale Girard
At-Large Councilor Michael Demars by Zoom
Assistant Mayor Allen Damren
Mayor Charlene Lovett
At-Large Councilor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor Koloski
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Stone

Also present:

Edward Morris, City Manager
Mary Walter, Finance Director

Absent:

Ward II Councilor James Contois

AGENDA CHANGES

None

CITIZEN’S FORUM

None

NEW BUSINESS

A Motion was made by Councilor Girard and seconded by Councilor Matteau to take the budget discussion off the table.

Roll call vote:

Councilor O’Hearne – Yes
Councilor Girard - Yes
Councilor Demars - Yes
Assistant Mayor Damren - Yes

Councilor Matteau - Yes

Councilor Koloski – Yes

Councilor Stone - Yes

Mayor Lovett - Yes

Motion carried 8-0

This meeting is to proceed with the Budget, public hearing and vote.

Resolution 2022-1 Tax Anticipation Note – Public Hearing

Finance Director Walter stated they do not anticipate using TAN funds, it's just in case something arises then the city has it available.

BE IT RESOLVED by the Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, after public hearing duly noticed, pursuant to the Municipal Finance Act, that the City Treasurer, with the approval of the City Manager, is hereby authorized to issue and sell notes of the City of Claremont, in an amount not to exceed \$4,000,000.00 in anticipation of receipt of taxes for the fiscal year 2022.

Such amount will not exceed the total tax levy for the year 2021. *(Majority Vote Required)*

Public Hearing was opened. No one from the public hearing spoke. Hearing was closed.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Assistant Mayor Damren and seconded by Councilor O'Hearne to adopt Resolution 2022-1 Tax Anticipation Note.

Roll call vote:

Councilor O'Hearne – Yes

Councilor Girard - Yes

Councilor Demars - Yes

Assistant Mayor Damren - Yes

Councilor Matteau - Yes

Councilor Koloski – Yes

Councilor Stone - Yes

Mayor Lovett - Yes

Motion carried 8-0

The next resolution concerned the General Fund budget. Both Councilors, Koloski and Girard, stated that they did not want to cut the \$50,000 in GASB funds nor cut the \$5,000 in traffic lights. Councilor Koloski stated that he has sat in this seat for too many years as Director Walter explains why we should be putting money aside for GASB and we never do. Councilor Girard

asked City Manager Morris if he felt that he could still get to the \$1 million in roads once we reassessed in January if we cut it now.

There was much discussion as to the validity of creating a part time position in Planning & Development and several councilors mentioned a letter, they had received from a part time employee of the city for over 20 years who vocalized the fact that the council was considering creating a new position when they can't fairly compensate current employees. The benefit and need for cleaning up blight and staying on target with council goals to reduce blight while growing the tax base was a key factor in wanting to fund that part time position.

Mayor Lovett asked Chief Burr what the impact would be if the \$5,000 was not restored. Chief Burr gave a brief history, we could lose an intersection at any time and that would costly.

Mayor Lovett asked if it was the wish of the council is to restore \$50,000 and the \$5,000 for traffic lights.

Finance Director Walter wanted to clarify to Councilor Koloski that the city has budgeted money for GASB in past years; in 2012 it was \$112,000, 2014 it was \$160,000 and in 2015 it was \$50,000; just not since then.

Councilor Girard wanted to speak about the position that was supposed to be a grant writer and from information they received recently learned that the position is actually a position to help Director Merrill.

Councilor Matteau said she remembers the conversation at the original budget meeting being Director Merrill saying a part-time zoning administrator would be more helpful for her office at this time.

City Manager Morris said have a Zoning Administrator would be helpful in our fight to get rid of blight.

Councilor Demars stated he also does support a grant administrator but agrees that it will not happen in this budget. Not in favor of \$40,000 for the Zoning Administrator.

Director Merrill gave a quick background of the needs of a Zoning Administrator in the Planning Office. This year has been a very busy year with many projects going on.

Councilor Matteau stated she believes this is the greatest area that we are open for litigation. We have to have someone that knows the rules and ordinances of the city. We all remember the Great Lakes lawsuit that we paid a lot of money for mistakes.

Councilor Stone asked how many vacancies there currently are at the Planning Office; Director Merrill said only 1; the Project Manager.

After listening to the various discussions on the part time zoning administrator position Councilor O’Hearne is going to change his stance and will support the \$40,000.

Councilor Girard asked if the \$5,000 we added to anticipated revenue was feasible if the position was not for a grant administrator. City Manager Morris said he is comfortable leaving that in the budget.

City Manager Morris felt that he might still be able to reach the council’s goal of \$1 million for the roads.

It was the consensus of council to reduce paving to \$745,950 and, as Mayor Lovett pointed out, with the encumbrance of \$65,000 they just passed last week, the paving budget, before the council reassesses it in December, will be \$810,950.

Mayor Lovett had asked if we could get a sense of where we are at for the September meeting and City Manager Morris felt that was really early. He said he understands the council’s goals for roads and felt confident that we should have a good idea by the December meeting so it was decided to put the update on the first meeting in December. Mayor Lovett asked how much was in the compensation reserve account. Director Walter estimated that there was about \$560,000 set aside.

Resolution 2022-2 To Adopt the 2022 General Fund Budget for the City of Claremont –
Public Hearing

WHEREAS in accordance with the Charter of the City of Claremont, and the Statutes of the State of New Hampshire, the City Council is required to establish a budget for its appropriations and revenues for its municipal activities; and

WHEREAS in accordance with said Charter, a public hearing was held on June 30, 2021;

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, that it adopts the following for its proposed expenditures and revenues for all departments for its 2022 fiscal year as follows. *(Majority Vote Required)*

2022 GENERAL FUND

Expenditure Summary:

Policy and Administration

Policy	\$ 589,120
City Administration	914,189
Elections & Registrations	11,550

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Assessing	196,907
Municipal Complex	399,017
Planning & Development	889,355
General Services	1,039,380
Public Safety	
Communications – 911	\$ 594,724
Police Department	3,216,129
Fire Department	2,550,496
Health & Welfare	
Welfare Department	\$ 392,979
Public Works	
Sanitation	\$ 221,076
Streets & Roads	3,397,629
Library	417,738
Debt Service	\$ 1,127,872
Public Service Enterprises	
Cemetery	\$ 193,539
Airport	120,465
Recreation & Parks	
Parks	\$ 402,569
CSB-Recreation	1,153,011
Outside Agency	\$ 30,000
TOTAL	\$17,850,745

Revenue Summary:

Taxes	\$ 17,050
Interest on Taxes	381,000
State of New Hampshire	1,363,997

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Licenses/Permits/Fees	2,246,230
Departmental Revenue	1,248,488
Rent of City Property	78,168
Payments in Lieu of Taxes	112,111
Miscellaneous Revenue	74,730
From Trust Related Funds	78,460
From Fund Balance	629,370
From Capital Reserve	34,500

REVENUE TOTAL	\$ 6,264,104
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A motion was made by Councilor Girard and seconded by Assistant Mayor Damren to adopt the 2022 General Fund Budget for the City of Claremont.

Public Hearing was opened. No one from the public hearing spoke. Hearing was closed.

Roll call vote:

Councilor O’Hearne – Yes
Councilor Girard - Yes
Councilor Demars - Yes
Assistant Mayor Damren - Yes
Councilor Matteau - Yes
Councilor Koloski – Yes
Councilor Stone - Yes
Mayor Lovett - Yes

Motion carried 8-0

Resolution 2022-3 To Adopt the 2022 Water Division Budget for the City of Claremont – Public Hearing

WHEREAS in accordance with the Charter of the City of Claremont and the Statutes of the State of New Hampshire, the City Council is required to establish a budget for its appropriations and revenues for its municipal activities; and

WHEREAS in accordance with said Charter, a public hearing was held on June 30, 2021 to provide oral and written comments on said proposed appropriations and revenues; and

WHEREAS the City of Claremont Water and Sewer Divisions are operated as separate entities and by revenues derived from their individual enterprises;

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, that it hereby adopts the following for its proposed expenditures and revenues for the Water Division as follows. *(Majority Vote Required)*

2022 PROPOSED WATER DIVISION BUDGET

REVENUE

Water Revenue	\$1,986,007
Miscellaneous Revenue	27,200
From Retained Earnings/Fund Balance	58,559

TOTAL

\$2,071,766

EXPENSE

Water Department	\$2,071,766
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TOTAL

\$2,071,766

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Damren and seconded by Councilor Matteau to adopt Resolution 2022-3 Water Division Budget for the City of Claremont.

Public Hearing was opened. No one from the public hearing spoke. Hearing was closed.

Roll call vote:

Councilor O’Hearne – Yes
 Councilor Girard - Yes
 Councilor Demars - Yes
 Assistant Mayor Damren - Yes
 Councilor Matteau - Yes
 Councilor Koloski – Yes
 Councilor Stone - Yes
 Mayor Lovett - Yes

Motion carried 8-0

Resolution 2022-4 To Adopt the 2022 Sewer Division Budget for the City of Claremont – Public Hearing

WHEREAS in accordance with the Charter of the City of Claremont and the Statutes of the State of New Hampshire, the City Council is required to establish a budget for its appropriations and revenues for its municipal activities; and

WHEREAS in accordance with said Charter, a public hearing was held on June 30, 2021 to provide oral and written comments on said proposed appropriations and revenues; and

WHEREAS the City of Claremont Water and Sewer Divisions are operated as separate entities and by revenues derived from their individual enterprises;

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, that it hereby adopts the following for its proposed expenditures and revenues for the Sewer Division as follows. *(Majority Vote Required)*

2022 PROPOSED SEWER DIVISION BUDGET

REVENUE

Sewer Revenue	\$2,524,570
Miscellaneous Revenue	411,929
To retained earnings	<u>(48,395)</u>

TOTAL	\$2,888,104
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EXPENSE

Sewer Department	\$2,888,104
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TOTAL	\$2,888,104
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A motion was made by Councilor Matteau and seconded by Assistant Mayor Damren to adopt Resolution 2022-4 Sewer Division Budget for the City of Claremont

Public Hearing was opened. No one from the public hearing spoke. Hearing was closed.

Roll call vote:

Councilor O'Hearne – Yes
Councilor Girard - Yes
Councilor Demars - Yes
Assistant Mayor Damren - Yes
Councilor Matteau - Yes
Councilor Koloski – Yes
Councilor Stone - Yes

Mayor Lovett - Yes
Motion carried 8-0

Councilor Koloski asked to be excused at 7:14pm.

Resolution 2022-5 To Adopt the 2022 Downtown Tax Increment Finance District Budget
for the City of Claremont – Public Hearing

WHEREAS in accordance with the Charter of the City of Claremont and the Statutes of the State of New Hampshire, the City Council is required to establish a budget for its appropriations and revenues for its municipal activities; and

WHEREAS in accordance with said Charter, a public hearing was held on June 30, 2021 to provide oral and written comments on said proposed appropriations and revenues; and

WHEREAS in accordance with RSA 162-K:12 the City Council must review and approve the operating budget of a tax increment finance district;

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, that it hereby adopts the following for its proposed expenditures and revenues for the Downtown Tax Increment Finance District. *(Majority Vote Required)*

**2022 PROPOSED TAX INCREMENT FINANCE
DISTRICT BUDGET – DOWNTOWN**

REVENUE

Revenues	\$719,550
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TOTAL	\$719,550
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EXPENSE

Expenses	\$719,550
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TOTAL	\$719,550
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A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Damren and seconded by Councilor Girard to adopt Resolution 2022-5 Downtown Tax Increment Finance District Budget for the City of Claremont.

**Public Hearing was opened. No one from the public hearing spoke. Hearing was closed.
Roll call vote:**

Councilor O'Hearne – Yes
Councilor Girard - Yes
Councilor Demars - Yes
Assistant Mayor Damren - Yes
Councilor Matteau - Yes
Councilor Stone - Yes
Mayor Lovett - Yes
Motion carried 7-0

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Councilor O'Hearne asked where we were with the Police Commission Ordinance. He felt that as soon as the State passed the change the city administration should have had the ordinance ready to go. City Manager Morris said we are working on it; it's been a very busy time.

Councilor Stone asked if tonight's meeting was available for public input on the zoom platform. City Manager Morris said it was not. Councilor Stone would like to discuss the zoom platform at a later meeting.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None

ADJOURNMENT

At 7:19 p.m., a motion was made by Councilor O'Hearne and seconded by Councilor Stone to adjourn.

Roll call vote:

Councilor O'Hearne – Yes
Councilor Girard - Yes
Councilor Demars - Yes
Assistant Mayor Damren - Yes
Councilor Matteau - Yes
Councilor Stone - Yes
Mayor Lovett - Yes
Motion carried 7-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Gwendolyn Melcher
City Clerk